realistic. While India provided some arms to the Tibetan government in 1949–50 and protested Chinese actions, there was little else it could do.

Despite India's annoyance over China's actions, its ability to stop Beijing was extremely limited in a material sense, a point that was clearly recognized by Indian decision-makers, civilian and military. Delhi was also keen to engage and partner communist China in emerging Asia and on the larger stage of world politics. This was not idealism. China was widely recognized as a Great Power – President Roosevelt had insisted that it be one of the permanent five in the UN Security Council and the first signatory to the UN Charter. By any standard, it commanded enormous military power after the civil war. India could not match it, even in 1949. By engaging Beijing, Nehru hoped that China would be a stabilizing Great Power, a partner in the international order, and a peaceful neighbour.

Delhi therefore accepted Beijing's takeover of Tibet. Indeed, it was positively helpful. In 1950, when El Salvador sought to move a UN resolution against China's actions in Tibet, India refused to go along and in fact tried to stop the move. Also in 1950, Washington sought Delhi's cooperation in arming the Tibetan resistance. Here too India refused. By 1951, Beijing and Lhasa had signed a seventeen-point agreement on the future of their relationship. In essence, the agreement allowed China to absorb Tibet. In return, the region would have a degree of autonomy: Tibetans would get to keep their political system; the status, functions, and powers of the Dalai Lama and religious freedom would be protected; and the development of Tibet's language and school system would be in local hands as would the process of religious reforms. India then began negotiations with China over its own rights and facilities in Tibet. This resulted in the 1954 'Agreement Between the Republic of India and the People's Republic of China on Trade and Intercourse Between Tibet Region of China and India'. By signing the agreement, India gave up all its rights and most of its properties in Tibet while retaining its trade agencies as well as access and staying facilities for its religious pilgrims. Most of all, though, the accord underlined Indian acceptance of China's full ownership of Tibet. Once again, Delhi had little choice given Chinese power and India's desire